



THE JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Records and Information Management Policy

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1.0 Introduction

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) is the premier law enforcement agency in Jamaica. It was established in 1716 by the British colonial government as the Jamaica Militia and later assumed its current name in 1867 when the Police Service was formed. Over the years, the JCF has undergone several changes including the introduction of modern policing strategies such as community policing in support of its mandate to maintain public order and safety, prevent and detect crime and protect life and property.

The Administration Branch, under the leadership of an Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) is mandated to manage personnel and administrative records of the JCF. It is responsible to ensure that records are properly classified, stored and can be easily retrieved when requested. The records managed by the Branch are unique in that they contain sensitive information relating to personnel, administrative investigations, intelligence gathering and discipline among other activities associated with the Force's service delivery. Separate from administrative records, the Force generates a number of other records used to encapsulate reports from citizens and members which have to be incorporated into policy to facilitate proper accountability.

Consequently, the Force implemented various systems geared at improving management of records. These initiatives led to the introduction of Application System 400 (AS400) which became operational in 1993 to capture personnel information; this was later replaced by the Personnel Management System (PMS) in 2002. The first electronic filing system known as the Personnel Information Registration System (PIRS) was introduced in 2003 and used to manage information on the creation and movement of files at Police Headquarters. The File Tracking System (FTS) replaced the PIRS in 2018 and was implemented across several Area/Branch and Divisional Headquarters to improve accountability.

The JCF further improved its records and information management system through the creation and implementation of the Enterprise File Tracking System (EFTS), which enables formations to create and monitor critical records at the local level. Following on that success, in 2019, the JCF's Registry Department launched the DocuShare File Management System which is used to store files digitally, reduce storage and allow for easier access to and retrieval of information from files. Despite these developments, the JCF still faces significant challenges in records management. One major challenge is the absence of a clear policy to treat with retention periods and process for disposal of records.

Records management within the JCF has evolved over time and while the accountability framework for files and correspondence within the Force has been strengthened, there remain gaps in the accountability for station records. The development of the JCF RIM policy will therefore transform and modernize all records within the organization as it will establish clear standards and facilitate accountability and improved service delivery.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this RIM Policy is to provide the framework for the standardized management of official records in the ***Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF)*** and to ensure that:

- 2.1 all activities and decisions are fully and accurately documented, managed and monitored in accordance with the regulatory framework and the life cycle principles of records creation, maintenance, use and disposal;

- 2.2 there is increased adherence to existing records and archives legislation and to promote the provision of the requisite infrastructure, as well as the provision of human and material resources for the effective and efficient management of the records and information assets of JCF;
- 2.3 there is accessibility and timely sharing of information within the JCF and its portfolio entities and protection of confidentiality of information;
- 2.4 the performance of daily activities is enhanced to support decision making and service delivery, by facilitating ease of access, easy retrieval and speedier delivery of information; and
- 2.5 the Vision 2030, National Development Plan is supported to reflect the country's obligation for transparency to its citizens.

2.5.1 Benefits

This Policy is also intended to provide the following benefits to the JCF:

- a) strengthened framework for a coherent, coordinated recordkeeping practices, processes and systems for both manual and electronic management of records media;
- b) create a climate that will ensure the ongoing integrity and accessibility of records;
- c) improve accountability and program delivery;
- d) contribute to the effective, efficient and ethical delivery of quality outcomes;
- e) promote ethical and professional business practices;
- f) improved decision making through the availability of information;
- g) enhanced service delivery to citizens and businesses through greater responsiveness and delivery of readily available information;
- h) improved and integrated communication within JCF and with other Government institutions;
- i) reduced operating costs through the efficient and effective management of space, equipment and technology, and through the application of records disposition procedures
- j) compliance with the provisions of legislative and regulatory frameworks underpinning records and information management as well as legislation under JCF;
- k) Protection and support for JCF through the management of risks associated with the existence or non-existence of evidence during litigations;
- l) efficiency and effectiveness in the management of JCF through improved arrangement and storage of records, improved turn-around times and protection of confidential official information;
- m) assimilation of new records management technologies to leverage efficiency, economy and effectiveness and an e-governance framework in JCF;

- n) preservation of the national memory through documenting and preserving records and archives with historical value to the nation monetized cultural assets;
- o) safeguard vital information, which is critical for business continuity in the event of a disaster; and
- p) increase in qualified RIM practitioners within JCF.

3.0 Scope

This Policy encompasses records in all media or format and covers all portfolios, areas, and divisions of the JCF. All employees of the JCF are required to safeguard its records and ensure compliance with the RIM policy and procedures. The Policy covers:

- 3.1 the minimum requirements that must be met for the records created and/or received to be considered as authentic records of the business activities they represent;
- 3.2 systems, processes, infrastructure and resource requirements to ensure the integrity, security, retrievability and usability of records; and
- 3.3 responsibilities for RIM at all levels; and provision for the review of the RIM Policy at regular intervals.

4.0 Abbreviation and Acronyms

AAC	Archives Advisory Committee
ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
ATI	Access to Information Act
CCM	Collaborative Case Management
CP	Commissioner of Police
DIAS	Documentation, Information and Access Services
DoD	Department of Defence
DNA	Deoxyribonucleic Acid
ECM	Enterprise Content Management
EFTS	Enterprise File Tracking System (EFTS)
eRIM	Electronic Records and Information Management
FTS	File Tracking System
GISAD	General International Standard for Archival Description
GoJ	Government of Jamaica
HR	Human Resources
ICT	Information and Communications Technology
ICTD	Information and Communication Technology Division
ISO	International Standard Organization
JARD	Jamaica Archives and Records Department
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
JRIMC	Joint Reference Information Management Capability
MDA	Ministries, Departments, and Agencies
RIM	Records and Information Management
PMS	Personnel Management System
PIRS	Personnel Information Registration System

5.0 Definition

- 5.1 **Metadata-** is the data that describes data or information. Records metadata is divided into three main types: structural metadata – used to describe the relationship between records, such as a file or container, or the format of the record.
- 5.2 **Disposition-** disposition means disposal of records no longer needed for day-to-day operations by a unit, through destruction, secure destruction, or transfer to the Archives.
- 5.3 **CAPSTONE Approach-** is a method of email management that bases appraisal and scheduling on the account owner's role or position rather than individual email content, as a means of simplifying and automating management.
- 5.4 **Active Record** - is considered to be active when used on a regular basis for example the personnel records of current employees.
- 5.5 **Semi- Active Record-** is considered as semi active if it is referenced once per month.
- 5.6 **Inactive Record** - is considered inactive when it is referenced fewer than ten times per year.
- 5.7 **Temporary Record-** does not have continuing or lasting value to the organization.
- 5.8 **Long term Record-** has continuing value and is held indefinitely or for a specified period.
- 5.9 **Vital Record-** essential to the organization's continuation and or resumption of operation following a disaster.
- 5.10 **Current Records** - records that are necessary for conduction the current business of an office and that must be maintained, therefore, in office space and equipment.
- 5.11 **Semi- Current** – records required infrequently in the conduct of current business that they should be moved to a holding area or directly to a records centre.
- 5.12 **Non- Current-** records that are no longer required in the conduct of current business and therefore can be accessioned by an archival repository or destroyed.
- 5.13 **Non-records** - shall be defined as documents such as drafts, worksheets, routine memos, or extra copies created for convenience or distribution, that have no retention value and have no need for filing. This definition shall be used as a guideline for the disposal of documents that are not records.

6.0 Responsibilities

The overall responsibility for this policy will reside with the Commissioner of Police.

6.1 Institutional Responsibility

The implementation of this policy resides with the Commissioner of Police, through the JCF RIM Committee.

6.2 Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP)

Administration/RIM Custodian's has direct responsibility for the JCF RIM Policy and shall be responsible for the implementation of the RIM Programme in keeping with the GoJ RIM Policy. He/she will:

- 6.2.1 In consultation with the JCF RIM Committee prepare and submit to the JARD the JCF RIM Policy and Procedures Manual, which shall be aligned to the GoJ RIM Policy and Procedures Manual.
- 6.2.2 Monitor the RIM Programme by ensuring all the stakeholders adhere to the guidelines.
- 6.2.3 Adhere to all RIM related legislative requirements.
- 6.2.4 Facilitate the audit of RIM systems of the JCF for efficiency and effectiveness by the Government Archivist at least once every two years.
- 6.2.5 Accept and review annual summaries of the state of records from the portfolio entities by February of each year.

6.3 Employees Responsibility

- 6.3.1 Records in all formats and media are to be managed according to the processes that ensure compliance with the GoJ's RIM Policy. JCF records will be classified, retained, archived or destroyed in accordance with this policy and related procedures and guidelines issued by JARD from time to time.
- 6.3.2 Heads of Department in collaboration with their units and the ACP Administration shall manage the JCF records in their possession or control and retain them in such a way that they are readily accessible and retrievable.
- 6.3.3 All JCF units and departments shall prepare and implement records classification and retention schedules that apply to the records in their possession or under their control. The schedules will be developed in collaboration with the Records Appraisal Sub-Committee and approved by the RIM Committee and JARD.
- 6.3.4 All employees shall be held accountable for the records which they create, use or manage. Regardless of their level, they must be aware of their responsibilities to manage the records created or used by them or those under their control or in their possession.
- 6.3.5 All employees shall be accountable and responsible for complete and accurate records that document their business functions, activities, decisions, transactions and operations.

- 6.3.6 All employees of the JCF who are departing the JCF shall surrender all or any records in their custody to their immediate supervisors. Supervisors/responsible officer must ensure that records are handed-over.

6.4 Responsibility of ICT Department

- 6.4.1 It is the responsibility of the ICTD staff to ensure that the ICTD system has records management functionality. They must also maintain supporting technology including having appropriate system accessibility, security and back-up.
- 6.4.2 The ICTD staff must also ensure that any actions such as removing data from systems or folders be undertaken in accordance with this policy. It is the responsibility of both ICTD and RIM staff to ensure that records generated by ICTD systems are effectively managed.

6.5 Accountability for RIM

6.5.1 RIM Committee

The RIM Committee shall be constituted by the Commissioner of Police who shall designate two members of the Senior Management Team as Chairperson and Co-Chairperson. The Records Manager of the JCF shall perform the secretariat functions of the Committee. The RIM Committee shall comprise representatives as follows:

- i. Chairman - Assistant Commissioner of Police, Administration Branch
- ii. Co-Chairman - Senior Superintendent of Police, Administration Branch
- iii. Senior Officer - Inspectorate and Professional Standards Oversight Bureau (IPROB)
- iv. Senior Officer - Criminal Investigation Branch (CIB)
- v. Senior Officer - JCF Personnel Officer
- vi. Director - Information and Communications Technology Division (ITCD)
- vii. Director - JCF Human Resource Division
- viii. Senior Officer - Legal Affairs Division
- ix. Director - Policy, Planning, Research & Development Branch (PRDB)
- x. JARD Analyst
- xi. Senior Officer - JCF Finance Branch
- xii. Registrar - Headquarters Registry
- xiii. Secretariat

6.5.2 Terms of Reference for RIM Committee

The core Terms of Reference for the RIM Committee shall be set out by Administrative Circular issued by JARD from time to time, in consultation with the JCF, to include the following minimum functions:

- a) development of internal RIM Policies and RIM procedural manuals (to include the treatment of e-RIM and audio-visual records);
- b) development of retention and disposal schedules;
- c) development of internal classification protocols which are compatible with the established GoJ classification scheme as existing from time to time;

- d) provision of advice, as needed, with respect to the provision of access to official records to the public in accordance with the ATI Act and any other laws;
- e) provision of advice on the roles and responsibilities to be ascribed various categories of staff;
- f) oversight of JCF compliance with GoJ and internal RIM policy and procedural manuals;
- g) serve as a point of contact for JARD on RIM matters, particularly, the implementation of the GoJ RIM Programme; and
- h) meet at least twice per year and minutes of the RIM Committee meetings shall be compiled and maintained.

6.5.3 **Ministry Roles and Responsibilities**

The JCF shall liaise with the portfolio/parent Ministry's RIM Committee as needed and for reporting purposes.

- i. Each year, a meeting shall be convened by the Chair of the Ministry's RIM Committee and shall be attended by at least one representative from each Department and Agency of the Ministry.
- ii. The Records Manager of JCF shall attend meetings convened by the chair of the portfolio Ministry RIM Committee.

6.5.4 **JARD Roles and Responsibilities**

JARD shall exercise oversight on the management of current and semi-current records in the JCF and for the maintenance and preservation of archival records transferred to its custody. JARD will be the responsible authority for the approval of the following RIM documentation which has been internally approved by the JCF:

- i. RIM Policy;
- ii. RIM Procedures Manual;
- iii. Classification Scheme; and
- iv. Disposition of official records through approval of the JCF Retention/Disposition Schedules by the Archives Advisory Committee.

7.0 **Policy Statement**

The purpose of this policy is to establish and maintain an integrated, standardized and secure records and information management programme within the JCF; which facilitates the efficient access to records and archival materials; preserves and leverages the JCF historical, informational, and cultural assets; as well as enables efficient service delivery, enhanced decision making and overall attainment of national developmental goals.

7.1 **Policy Principles and Benefits**

This Policy seeks to increase adherence to existing records and archives legislation and to promote the provision of the requisite infrastructure, as well as the provision of human and material resources. This Policy will ensure the effective and efficient management of records

and information assets of the JCF. The management of records and information in the *JCF* is guided by the following principles which are defined below:

- 7.1.1 **Accountability:** The JCF shall be held accountable for the proper management of their records and information and shall appoint a senior officer to oversee the RIM system.
- 7.1.2 **Integrity:** The JCF shall, for purposes of operationalizing this policy, establish, adopt and maintain adequate records management policies and procedures to guarantee the integrity, authenticity and reliability of all official records whilst fostering efficiency and effectiveness in public service delivery.
- 7.1.3 **Transparency:** The JCF business processes and activities including its information governance programme shall be documented in an open and verifiable manner and that documentation shall be available to all personnel, appropriate interested parties and the public at large.
- 7.1.4 **Protection of Records:** All users of official records shall accord them appropriate care, confidentiality and protection, in order to safeguard their value as records whilst not violating legal or other requirements of privacy or confidentiality.
- 7.1.5 **Availability:** All records and information of the JCF shall be maintained in a manner that facilitates their timely and efficient retrieval and usage.
- 7.1.6 **Compliance:** The JCF shall create, capture, manage, use and dispose of records in accordance with this policy and in keeping with all other legislation governing or having implications for record keeping as may be promulgated from time to time by the Government of Jamaica (GoJ).
- 7.1.7 **Retention and Disposition:** All records and information of the JCF shall be kept and maintained in accordance with applicable records retention/disposal schedules and shall be disposed of or transferred to the national archival depository as soon as they have served their operational purpose.
- 7.1.8 **Government-wide RIM Systems:** The JCF will support the GoJ's initiative of a standardized RIM system.

7.2 Policy Objectives and Strategies

7.2.1 Organizational Structure and Human Resources for RIM

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To provide JCF with the structures and human resources needed to discharge its functions and mandate.
- ii. To improve RIM practices in JCF through the training and capacity building of records management staff.

- iii. To ensure that the RIM staff in JCF has adequate qualifications and experience in records and information management.
- iv. To provide equitable conditions of service for RIM staff in JCF and to make provision for career pathways that will facilitate career progression and staff retention.
- v. To employ appropriate strategies for RIM capacity building within JCF.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. It shall be mandatory for RIM staff, to have formal qualifications in records and information management on recruitment and if already appointed such qualifications to be obtained within a designated timeframe.
- ii. JCF shall make adequate provision for career pathways that provide for progression through the ranks to higher positions, as competencies, volume and complexity dictate.
- iii. The RIM job functions in JCF, shall be streamlined to ensure occupiers of RIM related posts are in fact executing the appropriate functions.
- iv. The position of Records Manager/Access Officer (or its equivalent) shall be no lower than the third tier in the organisational structure.
- v. Efficiency audits shall be conducted in JCF to determine the number of staff required.
- vi. A Records and Information Management (RIM) Committee shall be established in JCF.
- vii. Efforts shall be made to ensure that the RIM enterprise has the resources and skills for the management of large volumes of digital records by either acquiring those critical skills or training existing internal resources to meet the requirements through a well-defined RIM/ICT learning programme.

7.2.2 RIM Committee

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To establish internal structures and mechanisms for achieving and maintaining full compliance with RIM policies, procedures and the requisite RIM standards.
- ii. To guide the composition of the RIM Committee so that it includes the key RIM stakeholders in JCF.
- iii. To give guidance on the key essentials of the Terms of Reference of the RIM Committee so as to ensure uniformity of purpose, operation and to prescribe minimum intervals for meetings of the RIM Committee.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

The JCF RIM Committee shall be constituted by the Commissioner of Police and adhere to the provisions of the Terms of Reference.

7.2.3 Creation, Capture and Registration of Records

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To ensure that all records created or received in the course of the business of the JCF (regardless of format) are captured and registered into the recordkeeping system.
- ii. To ensure that all records are authentic, accurate, complete, reliable and usable throughout their life.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. All records created or received in the normal course of business by JCF or its employees shall be the property of the GoJ and shall be captured and registered into a recordkeeping system. This shall include electronic and audio visual records.
- ii. All records creators and users shall be aware of the distinction between records and non-records. Once captured and registered into the recordkeeping system, records shall not be altered.
- iii. Officers shall be required to work on the network drives and save the information either in the shared folders or individual folders on the network as determined by JCF procedural manuals.
- iv. Document naming conventions shall be used for records as per the guidelines that will be issued by JARD.
- v. Metadata, which is data that provides information about the record, shall also be recorded as per guidelines that will be issued by JARD. When creating records, all officers shall ensure that they create records that are complete, accurate and contain sufficient information and details to enable them to provide authoritative and authentic evidence of the transactions that they represent.
- vi. The medium used when creating records shall be that which promotes long-term preservation, retrieval and usability of the records
- vii. Standards and guidelines on such issues as file formats and other technology selection issues, metadata standards, and wider information management standards shall be issued by JARD.
- viii. JCF shall include RIM awareness in staff induction programmes and the RIM procedures manual shall be made available to all staff either through the intranet or on the shared drives of each Unit/Department.

7.2.4 Classification and Indexing

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To provide for a JCF functional classification system that is in line with the Government wide classification system that standardizes filing (including electronic and audio visual records) across all MDAs.
- ii. To provide for the adoption of an expandable classification system that allows flexibility at the series and sub-series level.
- iii. To ensure that JCF has a specific file plan that is in accordance with the government-wide classification system.
- iv. To provide a basis for the development of retention and disposal schedules which are aligned to the classification scheme.

- v. To ensure that records are indexed so as to provide adequate data to facilitate search and retrieval.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. The JCF shall adopt and use the GoJ Functional Based Classification System based on the classification of the business activities of the entities. JCF, for purposes of uniformity, will be required to start with the common types of functions before the institution specific functions.
- ii. The Classification Scheme shall be used to develop the Master File Plan in JCF.
- iii. The Master File Plan shall be prepared at records series and sub-series levels. There shall be flexibility in terms of which records series and sub-series to expand, depending on the detailed activities and transactions of the particular function, unit or office.
- iv. The JARD Master Classification Scheme is a controlled document approved by the JRIMC and the Government Archivist. All officers that create receive and maintain records in their offices (paper and electronic) shall be required to classify the records as per the JARD File Classification Scheme.
- v. JCF shall adhere to guidelines, as issued by JARD, for the treatment and classification of audio visual records.
- vi. Records shall be indexed as per the guidelines provided in the JCF RIM Procedures Manual.
- vii. The Registry shall maintain complete inventories of all records in JCF.

7.2.5 Storage and Maintenance

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To provide for the appropriate storage, preservation and protection of records.
- ii. To apply standards regarding the environmental requirements for records.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. The JCF shall provide the buildings, office space, records storage space, shelving, RIM supplies, information communication technologies and other resources necessary for the safekeeping of the records in keeping with the goals and the objectives of the GoJ RIM Policy.
- ii. Records storage arrangements shall take into consideration the format, media, nature and use of the records, as well as migration requirements in the case of electronic and digital records.
- iii. Adequate storage space and facilities shall be provided to cater for current records in the Registry and operational areas.
- iv. The JCF shall provide appropriate repositories, with appropriate shelving and other equipment for the storage and management of semi-current records.

- v. Non-current records, both paper and electronic, shall be transferred to the JCF Records Centre/Records Storeroom/ or to the custody of the Government Records Centre, and, in the case of electronic non-current records, transferred to a designated repository governed by JCF under the custodianship of JARD.
- vi. Preservation requirements for records shall be incorporated into JCF Business Continuity Plan to ensure the continued availability of all records in the event of a disaster. The relevant plans shall be periodically tested through appropriate types of disaster recovery exercises.
- vii. The JCF shall be required to have clearly articulated environmental standards and controls for its records and archives.

7.2.6 Security Access, Use and Tracking of Records

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To ensure that all records are available and accessible for use.
- ii. To ensure that there are controls to regulate access to all records, including the security classification of records.
- iii. To ensure that the movement of all records is tracked and recorded.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. The design and acquisition of software which will enable the establishment of an electronic central registry shall be pursued over the medium to long term.
- ii. Procedures for access and use of all records shall be developed and enforced, and shall define access and authority controls, stipulating which officer can access what records and which access rights shall be enforced within the record keeping system.
- iii. To facilitate the granting of access rights, records shall be security classified and categorised according to their level of sensitivity. Records that are restricted shall be boldly stamped or watermarked to reflect their access status.
- iv. Appropriate systems shall be developed and used for the tracking of paper and electronic documents and records. This shall include both action and location tracking.
- v. All e-RIM systems in JCF shall provide for audit trails and/or event logs to record all actions applied on e-records within the system, the time, dates and persons responsible for the actions.
- vi. Public access to all JCF records shall be governed by the legislation relating to access and provision of information to the public.

7.2.7 Records Disposition

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To ensure the appraisal of all official records and the preparation of records retention/disposal schedules through consultative processes.
- ii. To provide for the timely disposal of records in accordance with the set retention periods.

- iii. To provide for the timely transfer and preservation of records with archival value.
- iv. To provide a procedural framework for treating with non-records.
- v. To strengthen the procedural framework for the treatment of official records held in the JCF.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. No official records shall be destroyed without the approval of the Archives Advisory Committee (AAC).
- ii. The appraisal of records and the preparation of records retention/disposal schedules shall be done at the macro-level, i.e. at records series and sub-series levels.
- iii. Non-records shall be defined as documents such as drafts, worksheets, routine memos, or extra copies created for convenience or distribution, that have no retention value and have no need for filing. This definition shall be used as a guideline for the disposal of documents that are not records.
- iv. Disposal of records should be in an appropriate and prescribed manner once their administrative, legal or fiscal use has expired. The requirements for retention should be sufficiently flexible so that retention is not a fixed period but may be event driven.
- v. JCF records of transitory value shall be disposed of by the Commissioner of Police in line with the retention/disposal schedules approved by the AAC. No record shall remain undisposed of more than six months after its due date for disposition.
- vi. Methods of disposition shall be appropriate to the type of record, and shall preserve the confidentiality of any information contained.
- vii. All official records with archival value shall be transferred to the custody of the Archives Unit.
- viii. All official records with archival value that are in the custody of the JCF and stored in a repository sanctioned by JARD shall be maintained in accordance with guidelines and conditions established by JARD.

7.2.8 Email Management

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To implement a system for the management of emails as official records of the GoJ.
- ii. To introduce the CAPSTONE approach under which emails of designated officers in JCF will be archived and preserved.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. Emails that are used to conduct the business of JCF are official records and shall be captured as records and managed in accordance with this Policy.
- ii. JCF shall invest in an email management system that will facilitate the capture and management of emails as official records of the GoJ and shall be deployed on government designated domains.
- iii. All emails held in JCF are the property of the GoJ. Therefore, users of these email systems shall not have any expectations of privacy.
- iv. Use of personal email addresses by JCF officers for official business is prohibited. If, because of system constraints/crashes, officers have to use alternate email addresses, these shall be in the name of the JCF, not personal addresses.
- v. Personal emails shall not be considered as official records and shall not be captured into the recordkeeping system.
- vi. E-mails that are deemed to have evidential value shall remain intact in terms of their structure, content and context to ensure they remain authentic and accurate for the entire duration they are serving business functions.
- vii. The RIM Committee in JCF shall designate levels at which officers' emails are required to be archived and preserved as per the CAPSTONE approach.
- viii. E-mails received by or initiated by JCF officers, including attachments, and which relate to the business activities of non-designated e-mail accounts, shall be retained in accordance with the established records retention/disposal schedules of JCF as approved by the AAC.
- ix. E-mails shall be subject to established access controls and regulations to protect against unauthorized or inappropriate access.
- x. JCF shall define categories of information that may not be transmitted via e-mail.

7.2.9 Information Sharing

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To promote the secure and confidential sharing of information between JCF and other MDAs.
- ii. To establish systems and processes which support the objective of the Access to Information legislation and the efficient management of information to facilitate access to official documents.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. The flow of information and sharing of data within and across public institutions shall be encouraged to promote common understanding and knowledge, inform decision making and improve service delivery.
- ii. JCF shall identify and classify their information in terms of what can be shared within the institution, what can be shared with public institutions,

what can be shared with non-public institutions, what can be shared with the general public and what should not be shared.

- iii. Provisions of various legislations governing disclosure of public information shall be complied with when sharing information with entities outside JCF.
- iv. Adequate technological infrastructure including ICTs shall be deployed to facilitate sharing of information, including but not limited to online sharing. Such technologies shall provide adequate security for information being shared.
- v. To promote information sharing and to enhance decision making within JCF, a consolidated list of the file plans and titles of files in the Registry, Units and individual offices shall be compiled and published in keeping with the GoJ RIM Procedural Manual. Any information of public policy or other relevance or significance, collected through research or surveys and whose value has cross-cutting benefits across the public sector, shall be shared with relevant MDAs in keeping with this Policy and any other information sharing guidelines/policies.
- vi. Procedures shall be developed and enforced for safeguarding confidential information shared by and with JCF to prevent unauthorized access.

7.2.10 ICT for RIM

a) Policy Objectives

- i. To support the RIM enterprise so as to consolidate the fragmented legacy of ICT solutions into an integrated environment that is responsive to change and supportive of the cost effective delivery of RIM objectives, customer related processes and online services.
- ii. To ensure the needs of JCF for an integrated ICT strategy are met, permitting the closest possible synergy across the extended RIM enterprise.
- iii. To provide a strategic and operational context for the evolution of ICT systems in response to the constantly changing needs of the RIM business environment.
- iv. To promote the establishment of e-RIM business continuity and disaster recovery plans.

b) Policy Strategies and Statements

- i. JCF shall procure its RIM ICT requirements as per its assessed RIM ICT maturity level.
- ii. When procuring an ECM system JCF will select from designated software packages identified by e-Gov. for use by MDAs.

- iii. JCF will adopt standards complementary to the DoD 5012 for the ECM and ISO-15489 for records management processes (see diagram at Appendix 2).
- iv. JCF shall deposit all audio-visual materials of archival value, which are official records, in the Audio-visual Unit, whether or not the works are published or unpublished. This will promote having completeness in records, as required by ISO 15489.
- v. JCF will deploy governance systems at the enterprise level that will authorise the disposal and migration of critical RIM ICT systems.
- vi. Recoverability, redundancy, continuity and sustainability of RIM in ICT systems shall be addressed at the time of design and shall be fully integrated across the entire JCF as a required management process.
- vii. Where applicable, JCF shall employ Collaborative Case Management (CCM) approaches, which leverage the core components of RIM including online links to case documents for rapid retrieval and review.
- viii. JCF shall complement perimeter security with a measured approach to managing internal information security by developing prescribed standards to manage and secure content using access controls and audit trails.
- ix. JCF acknowledges that it is desirable to bring a RIM ICT architect function into the RIM programme as early as possible to offer guidance, throughout the phases of the RIM implementation, on RIM ICT-specific information which should be gathered, steps which should be taken, and procedures which should be created. Architectural decisions related to RIM ICT should be traceable to policy decisions and their risk management.
- x. JCF shall involve ICT Director/Manager in the planning of ICT projects to ensure the new capability not only meets the business goals and strategic objectives, but also addresses the RIM Requirements.
- xi. RIM software and hardware shall conform to defined standards that promote interoperability for data, applications and technology.
- xii. RIM ICT initiatives shall be conducted in accordance with the enterprise plan promulgated by JCF. JCF shall pursue RIM ICT initiatives which conform to the blueprints and priorities established at the enterprise level.

8.0 Legislative Authority and Policies

- i. Constabulary Force Act, 1935
- ii. Fingerprint Act
- iii. DNA Evidence Act 2016
- iv. Criminal Records (Rehabilitation of Offenders) Act
- v. The Evidence (Special Measures) Act 2012
- vi. The Committal Proceedings Act 2013
- vii. Data Protection Act 2020
- viii. The Child Diversion Act
- ix. Court Administration Act
- x. Evidence Act, 1843 (Amended 2009)
- xi. Records Office Act, 1879, (Amended 1973)

- xii. Official Secrets Act, 1911
- xiii. Financial Audit & Administration Act (FAA), 1959 (Amended 2014)
- xiv. Archives Act, 1982 & Regulations, 1988
- xv. Copyright Act, 1993 (Amended 1999)
- xvi. Access to Information Act, 2002
- xvii. Access to Information Regulations, 2003
- xviii. Electronic Transactions Act, 2007
- xix. The Record Office (Archives) Rules, 1969
- xx. The Records Office Rules, 1975
- xxi. GoJ Records & Information Management Policy (2018).
- xxii. ISO 15489-1:2016, International Standard for Records Management
- xxiii. JS ISO 15489 (2004), Jamaica's Standard for Records Management
- xxiv. The Vision 2030, Jamaica National Development Plan
- xxv. The Public Sector Modernization Vision and Strategy 2002-2012
- xxvi. The National Information and Communications Technology Strategy 2007-2012
- xxvii. The ICT Policy 2011
- xxviii. The GoJ Staff Orders
- xxix. The Book of Rules for Guidance and General Direction of the JCF, 1988
- xxx. JCF Standing Orders

9.0 Policy Implementation

The implementation of this RIM Policy within the JCF will be guided by the relevant Laws of Jamaica along with the GoJ and the JCF Policies and Standard Operating Procedures listed at 8.0 above. This will be administered under the guidance of the aforementioned Committees and Sub Committees led by the Commissioner of Police.

9.1 Approval and Implementation

- 9.1.1 This RIM Policy shall take effect upon approval and promulgation by the Commissioner of Police.
- 9.1.2 The GoJ RIM Policy's overarching strategy and implementation plan shall guide the operationalization of this policy.

9.2 Monitoring and Evaluation

9.2.1 Commitment to Monitoring and Review

The JCF is committed to monitoring at regular intervals the implementation of, and compliance with, this policy. All staff of the *JCF* whose duties involve creating, managing and /or receiving records has a direct responsibility to ensure adherence with this policy. Measures will be instituted to ensure that staff complies with the Policy and that objectively verifiable evidence is provided at regular intervals to show the level of conformity by all concerned and remedial actions taken for non-compliance.

9.2.2 Monitoring Responsibilities of RIM Committee

Composite of RIM Committee

The duties of JCF RIM Committee shall include monitoring and reviewing implementation of the RIM Policy within the JCF. The RIM Committee shall therefore:

- i. Receive reports on the implementation of the RIM Policy by Divisions and Units within the JCF, and take appropriate actions based on the findings and recommendations.
- ii. Receive and submit to the JARD, as required by the Archives (Official Records) Regulations, 1988, an annual summary of official records in the custody of the JCF, not later than the 31st March each year.
- iii. The ACP Administration shall have direct responsibility for monitoring implementation of the RIM Policy, and gathering and maintaining, monitoring information and statistics for compilation of the performance reports.
- iv. Include in the Quarterly reports to the Commissioner of Police, status of implementation of the RIM Policy within the JCF, including corrective actions taken.

9.3 Internal and External Auditors

9.3.1 Internal auditors within the JCF shall be responsible for monitoring and reporting on compliance with this policy as part of their audit processes and reporting on risk management, governance, effectiveness of internal control measures, and on compliance of the RIM systems with laws, policies and regulations. The Audit shall be conducted to assess compliance with the (phase based) RIM Implementation Strategy of the GoJ.

9.3.2 The external auditors shall also, as part of the institutional effectiveness audits, include the auditing of the RIM systems in the JCF.

9.4 JARD Monitoring Function

9.4.1 JARD shall be responsible for actively implementing the RIM Programme across MDAs and for monitoring the overall compliance of the JCF with the RIM Policy using standardised monitoring and reporting instruments.

9.4.2 JARD uses the information from its compliance check as well as information from other sources such as the Auditor General, DDIAS and the Internal Auditors, to compile and submit annual reports to the portfolio Ministry with responsibility for Information on the overall compliance of MDAs. The latter report is tabled in the Houses of Parliament.

9.5 Policy Review

9.5.1 This policy shall be reviewed and/or updated at least once every Two (2) years. The ACP Administration, as the professional head for RIM in the JCF, shall initiate this review.

Appendix 1

Figure 1: ISO Complementary RIM Standards Diagram

